

Statistical Inference and Modeling

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Semester II, 2025

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10. K-nearest neighbor

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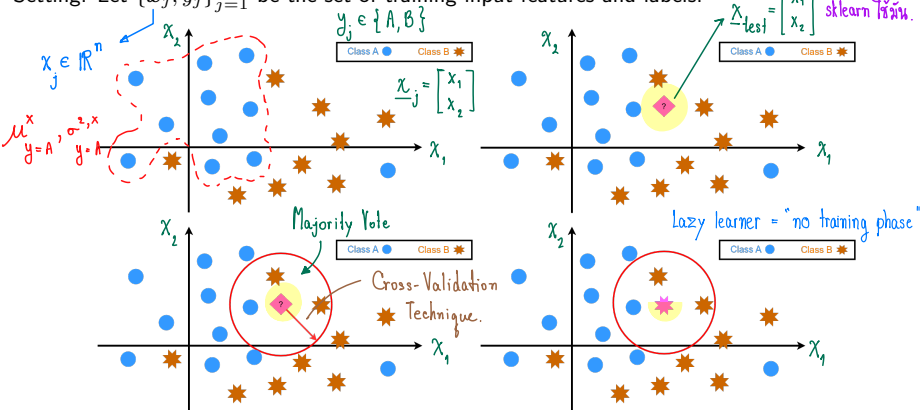
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- ① K-nearest neighbor
 - Probabilistic viewpoint
 - Effect of K in K-nearest neighbor

K-nearest neighbor —the algorithm

* No model parameter radius (กำหนดขอบเขตค้นหา) → ระบุอยู่ใน Paper.
* 1 Hyper parameter. # max. neighbors (เลือก K ตัวที่ใกล้สุด)

Setting: Let $\{x_j, y_j\}_{j=1}^m$ be the set of training input features and labels.



- Find the distance between the input feature and the training features.
- Identify K nearest training features Let $\text{Neigh}\{x_{\text{Test}}\}$ be an index set of the neighborhoods of x_{Test} . The prediction is the average of all training labels in the neighborhood set of x_{Test} :

Regression Tasks

$$\hat{y} = f(x_{\text{Test}}; K) = \frac{1}{K} \sum_{j \in \text{Neigh}\{x_{\text{Test}}\}} y_j$$

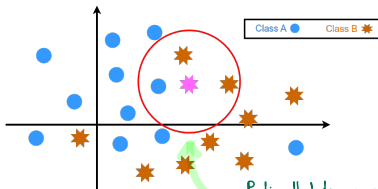
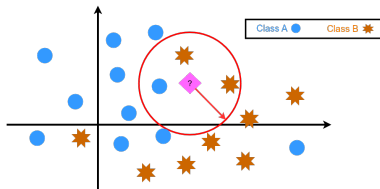
Classification

$$\hat{y} = \text{Mode}\{y_j \text{ for } j \in \text{Neigh}\{x_{\text{Test}}\}\}$$

K-nearest neighbor — decision boundaries

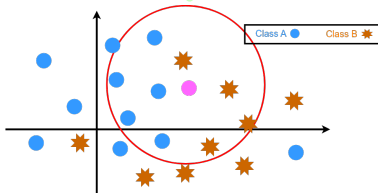
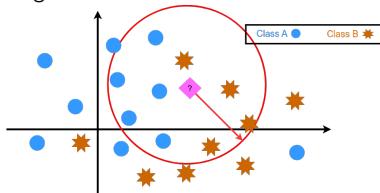
Setting: Let $\{\mathbf{x}_j, y_j\}_{j=1}^m$ be the set of training input features and labels.

Small radius



Radius that dangerous
→ different result.

Large radius



K-nearest neighbor — probabilistic viewpoint

The last step of finding the class associated with the majority of the K nearest training features (neighbors) could be done in the following steps:

- 1 count the number of neighbors belonging to each class.
- 2 compute the ratio between the counted number and K

Remind: Scale data ให้ Range
ใกล้เคียงกันด้วย เพราะ
ไม่จึ้น distance จะมีปัญหา

This is equivalent to estimating the conditional probability:

discriminative tasks $\rightsquigarrow$

$$p(Y = c | \mathbf{x}) = \frac{\text{\#points from } c\text{th class}}{K}$$

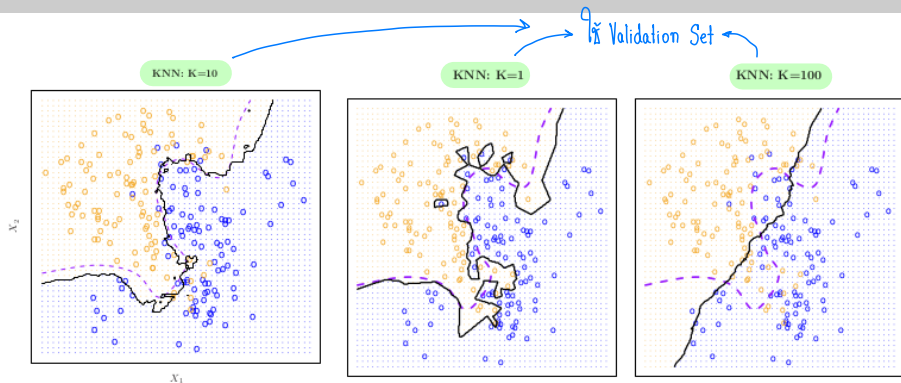
$\mathbf{x}_{\text{test}}$

ตอนนี้นำ K ไปได้
Hyperparameter.

The above Bayes rule is used in KNN to identify the class.

- In KNN, the class with the highest conditional probability will be identified as the class that the testing point $\mathbf{x}$ belongs to...
- The optimal value of K depends on the bias-variance trade-off. Small K provides the most flexible fit which has low bias but high variance.
- We can choose K from a plot of cross-validated MSE versus $\frac{1}{K}$.
- Note that the scale of variable matters because kNN detects the distance between observations (the variable with a larger scale affects more).
- It is advised to standardize data to have zero mean and unit variance.

Effect of K in K-nearest neighbor



— straight line is KNN, - - dashed line is Bayes decision.

- $K = 10$: kNN and Bayes decision boundaries are similar.
- $K = 1$: kNN boundary finds pattern in the data, and is **very flexible** with low bias — it is quite different from Bayes boundary
- $K = 100$: kNN is **less flexible** and is close to linear.
- K is generally taken to be an odd number to minimize ties.

- [1] Trevor Hastie, Robert Tibshirani, and Jerome Friedman. *The Elements of Statistical Learning*. Springer Series in Statistics. New York, NY, USA: Springer New York Inc., 2001.
- [2] Gareth James et al. *An Introduction to Statistical Learning: with Applications in R*. Springer, 2013. URL: <https://faculty.marshall.usc.edu/gareth-james/ISL/>.
- [3] Jitkomut Songsiri. “Statistical Learning”. In: in EE575 Random Processes for EE. Chulalongkorn University, 2022. Chap. 8. Introduction to Classification. URL: <http://jitkomut.eng.chula.ac.th/ee575.html>.